

Memo

To: Dr. Lisa Myers

From: Grace Tomallo

Date: May 8, 2026

Subject: Final Reflection Memo for ENGL 2210

This memo provides a conclusion to my development as a writer throughout the semester in ENGL 2210. Initially, I associated writing with creative expression and academic rigor; however, this course demonstrated the multitude of ways writing operates within a professional and technical setting. My overall proficiency in writing has increased significantly; I can more effectively organize ideas and content, write to diverse audiences, and work collaboratively with classmates. I have gained a greater appreciation for the role of visuals, formatting, editing, and digital media in technical communication and the incorporation of these elements in various forms of writing. The following portfolio contains completed assignments that represent my enhanced writing competencies in these specific areas.

The first course outcome is Project Planning. This means students will plan, research, and create papers and documents, in addition to producing audio and video projects and commentaries. An example of this outcome is the Pizza Roll Instruction Guide and video that my group did for the class. The purpose of this guide was to provide younger viewers with steps to make and cook Totino's Pizza Rolls safely. In the guide, the target audience was defined as "Males Age 10–14." The tools needed to make and cook the rolls were listed, step by step instructions on how to make and cook the rolls were given, and safety warnings were included. This project demonstrated Project Planning by requiring teamwork, planning, and organization. Students had to work together to organize all of the information and complete the tasks assigned to them.

One of the outcomes that we focused on in class was Project Analysis, where we looked at audience and the purpose of documents. In our most recent project, we analyzed a series of instructions on how to cook Pizza Roll's. The instructions that were provided to us were written for younger readers, just starting to read and write. The guide used short sentences, direct language and color to make the reading experience easy to understand. Through this project, I learned that good technical writing is about providing the audience with what they need, and not using obscure language.

Content Development was the third outcome tackled in this class where students learned to recognize the different genres and forms of technical writing. We practiced content development by writing several different types of technical writing such as resumes, reports, flyers, memos, and formal letters. An example of this outcome is my resume. My resume uses professional formatting, makes use of organized sections, and has proper use of technical language to effectively communicate my experience and skills. Another example of this outcome is my complaint letter to Transportation Services about the parking shortages on campus. In this letter, I effectively used formal writing to address the proper audience and solve a problem by suggesting that UNM use services such as UberX to help reduce congestion on campus.

The fourth outcome was Organizational Design, which focused on research skills and organizing information in a clear manner. The assignment that best demonstrated this outcome was the report “Homelessness in Albuquerque and What Can Be Done About It.” This project required a lot of research, and we utilized many different academic journals and databases. The report was organized into sections such as an abstract, a brief methodology explanation, results, recommendations, and references. My group and I learned a lot about the various causes and symptoms of homelessness, and we developed several potential solutions to the problem. One solution that we found was that supportive housing could help alleviate the problem of homelessness. Additionally, making sure that people who are in need of services have access to them is important.

This assignment taught me a lot about how important research and organization are in professional writing. It is essential to make sure that the information that is presented to a reader is accurate and up-to-date, and that it is presented in a clear manner. Although developing a formal report is not something that I typically do, I believe that I was successful in my endeavors in this assignment.

Written Communication was the fifth result I gained as a result of my academic progression. In this area, we learned about grammar, punctuation, and clarity in written communication. My Sting Emergency Instruction sheet was a good example of this. Since emergency procedures are typically implemented during a very urgent situation, therefore, they need to be explained clearly and shortly in writing. My document included brief instructions and active verbs such as Call a lifeguard and Contact emergency medical services. What I learned is that effective technical writing is simple to read, accessible, and straightforward.

My sixth outcome was Visual Communication. “My Garden Club” was a flyer created to advertise the monthly meetings of my Garden Club. I used large text, space, and organization in the flyer to clearly communicate the details of the meeting to the potential members. In addition, for our Burger King postmortem project, my group created a ten slide presentation. The presentation analyzed the different ethical issues present in the advertisement and provided Burger King with a plan to rectify the problems and re market the sandwich. The slides effectively communicated the details of our plan through the use of text, images, and organization. I gained knowledge of how design and layout can affect communication.

Of the seven outcomes, one was the “Reviewing and Editing” outcome, which looked at how to fully proofread, revise, and collaborate on content before finalizing a piece. Our Burger King group project really embodied this outcome, as we revised slides and grammar throughout the project, and even rearranged material to better suit our message. Through this process I learned that writing strong work is not just about putting pen to paper the first time, but also undergoing a lot of revision and collaboration with others.

The 8th outcome was Content Management. In order to achieve this outcome, students studied programs and digital organization in order to create technical documents. For this outcome, I showed knowledge of the different programs such as Microsoft Word and how to use them. I showed my ability to complete documents with proper formatting using programs like Canva and PowerPoint in my Burger King presentation and the Garden Club flyer. I learned that technology is now a huge part of how we communicate today.

Our ninth outcome was Production and Delivery. This means that students were expected to present information through a variety of different mediums. The Pizza Roll instructional was a great example of this. It was a written project that incorporated many different forms of media. The final product was a video that showed the steps to making the best Pizza Rolls ever. The other project that exemplified this outcome was our homelessness report. In this project we studied a topic of our choice regarding the issue of homelessness and then presented the information that we learned to the class.

Of all the items in this portfolio, I felt that my strongest item was the report "Homelessness in Albuquerque and What Can Be Done About It". It was a strong assignment for me because it demanded a high degree of research, organization, collaboration, audience awareness, and professional writing all at once, and I felt that I was able to fulfill these goals very well. It was a good report because it did a great job of presenting factual evidence, as well as providing concrete solutions to the problem of homelessness in Albuquerque.

Of the three pieces in the portfolio I would say that my weakest item is the Garden Club flyer. At first glance, the flyer looks ok, and it conveys the information needed to attend a meeting; however, as compared to my latter work for the class, my design could have been a lot better and certainly a lot more creative. Despite my design not being my best, the assignment was very useful in terms of gaining more knowledge and comprehension of design principles and how to connect with a specific audience, even if the execution was lacking in certain areas.

Technical writing is a tool that I can use not only in school but also in my future career. As a prospective business major, my goal is to open up my own bakery or restaurant. Effective communication is crucial and this unit has really taught me how to present material in a clear manner, organize, and modify messages for an audience. These skills will be helpful to me in the future when I write business plans, create materials for training employees, and write reports as well as other forms of professional communication.

This semester in ENGL 2210 I was really challenged to better my understanding of technical and professional communication. I spent the semester learning how to strengthen my research, organization, editing, and audience-awareness skills through all of the assignments. While I'm not perfect and can still be better in some areas, this semester has definitely helped me grow into a more confident writer for technical and professional settings.

If you have any questions regarding this reflection memo or portfolio, please feel free to contact me at gtomallo@unm.edu